

3.2.2 Functions with Return Values

return نتیجہ کال کرنے والے پروگرام کو واپس بھیجتا ہے تاکہ وہ متغیر میں محفوظ ہو سکے یا آگے حساب میں لگے۔

CS XII

Chapter 3: Programming Fundamentals

Lecture 11 of 18

3.2.2 Functions with Return Values

LEARN IT

A function can either **print** a result (show it on the screen) or **return** a result (send it back to the caller). A returned value can be stored in a variable, printed later, or used in a further calculation. The call is replaced by the returned value, as if you had written that value in its place.

```
def multiply(a, b):  
    return a * b  
  
result = multiply(5, 3)  
print("The answer is:", result)
```

OUTPUT

The answer is: 15

`multiply(5, 3)` evaluates to 15. That 15 is stored in `result`.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Print versus return. This is the difference examiners want.

```
def show_sum(a, b):  
    print(a + b)  
  
def give_sum(a, b):  
    return a + b  
  
x = show_sum(2, 3)  
print("stored from show_sum:", x)  
y = give_sum(2, 3)  
print("stored from give_sum:", y)  
print("double it:", y * 2)
```

OUTPUT

5
stored from show_sum: None
stored from give_sum: 5
double it: 10

`show_sum` prints 5 inside the function, then returns `None` (the default when there is no `return`). You cannot double that answer later. `give_sum` hands 5 back, so `y * 2` is 10. Use `print` for messages; use `return` for results the rest of the program still needs.

REMEMBER IT

return = send back; print = show now. `return` also **exits** the function immediately. Lines after `return` in the same function do not run.

COMMON MISTAKE

Writing `print(a * b)` inside `multiply` and then `result = multiply(5, 3)` stores `None` in `result`, not 15. If you later write `result + 1` you get `TypeError`. Return the number; let the caller decide whether to print it.

اردو میں سمجھیں

`return` نتیجہ کال کرنے والے پروگرام کو واپس بھیجتا ہے تاکہ وہ متغیر میں محفوظ ہو سکے یا آگے حساب میں لگے۔ اگر `return` نہ ہو تو فنکشن `None` دیتا ہے۔ `print` صرف اسکرین پر دکھاتا ہے؛ اس سے حاصل شدہ قیمت دوبارہ استعمال نہیں ہوتی۔

CHECK YOURSELF

1. What is stored in `result` after `result = multiply(5, 3)` with `return a * b`?
2. What does a function return if it has no `return` statement?

Answers: 1. 15. 2. `None` .

Next lecture: 3.2.3 Activity: Arithmetic Calculator Using Functions